

Grade 6 - World Geography and Ancient Civilization II - Latin America, South and East Asia, Oceania, Latin America, and Europe (Draft)

Overview

In grade 6, students will examine how movement and migration impacted the interactions between expanding civilizations through conquest and trade, including the physical and political geography and ancient societies of South and East Asia, Oceania, Latin America, and Europe. Students will note how geography, power, wealth, and religion influence culture, change, and development within civilizations as they examine how the perspectives of political science, economics, geography, history, and archaeology apply to the study of regions and countries. Students will develop an appreciation of cultural contributions (art, music, literature, architecture) and lasting achievements in science and technology. Grade 6 concludes with a study of government in Greece and Rome, which serves as a prelude to the study of civics in grade 8. Through an understanding of ancient history, students will develop an appreciation for the foundations of the modern world.

Looking Back

In grade 5, students examined how movement and migration impacted the interactions between expanding civilizations through conquest and trade, including the emergence and development of early societies in Western Asia, the Middle East, North Africa, and Sub-Saharan Africa.

Looking Ahead

In grade 7, students will build on their knowledge of Vermont and United States politics, geography, economics, and history as they re-visit the conflicts over slavery that continued into Reconstruction and beyond and led to the long struggle in the 19th and 20th centuries for civil rights.



Inquiry

Why inquiry? Using inquiry as an instructional model for the teaching of social studies allows students to authentically ask questions, search for and analyze evidence, and provide explanations and arguments to challenges facing their world.

The inquiry instructional model is driven by authentic questions or problems that have relevance for children. Students learn content, skills, and dispositions as they seek answers to questions and as they apply their learning to take informed action. Pioneered by Dewey (1938), inquiry is an attempt to make classroom experiences feel more like the authentic, curiosity-driven experiences that motivate learning outside of school. ([Using Inquiry to Prepare Students for College, Career, and Civic Life](#), elementary edition, p. 22)

The Inquiry Arc is defined in Dimension 1 (questioning) of the [College, Career, and Civic Life \(C3\) Framework for Social Studies State Standards](#). In this Framework, Dimension 3 (evidence sourcing), and Dimension 4 (communicating), as well as some evidence indicators found within Dimension 2 – History, have been combined with Dimension 1 into a singular Inquiry Process, as evidenced below. This Inquiry Process begins in the elementary grades and increases in depth and complexity as it spans through high school, preparing students to spiral their learning and skill acquisition in the social studies for college and career readiness.

Inquiry Process (K-12): Students act as social scientists as they ask questions, think critically, solve problems, and share conclusions.

C3 Indicators (6-8):

Constructing Compelling and Supporting Questions: D1.1, 2, 3; His. 12

Gathering and Evaluating Sources: D2. His. 6, 10, 12, 13; D3. 1, 2, 3

Communicating and Critiquing Conclusions: D2. His. 16; D4. 1, 2, 4

Overarching Themes:

- Emerging Governance
- Trade and Exchange
- Mastering Environments
- Connecting Worlds

Civics

Theme: Emerging Governance

Civic and Political Institutions

D2.Civ.2.6-8. Explain specific roles played by citizens (such as voters, jurors, taxpayers, members of the armed forces, petitioners, protesters, and office-holders).

D2.Civ.3.6-8. Examine the origins, purposes, and impact of constitutions, laws, treaties, and international agreements.

D2.Civ.5.6-8. Explain the origins, functions, and structure of government with reference to the U.S. Constitution, state constitutions, and selected other systems of government.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to identify those aspects of our democratic government that derived from early civilizations.	Ancient Greece • City-states with various forms of government – democracy in Athens, oligarchy in Sparta; varied structures – assemblies, councils, magistrates for defense, civil life and participatory governance Roman Republic and Empire • Republic with elected officials; transitioned to emperor rule; elected officials (senate, consul) later emperors for legal justice and military expansion • Legal systems

Participation and Deliberation: Applying Civic Virtues and Democratic Principles

D2.Civ.10.6-8. Explain the relevance of personal interests and perspectives, civic virtues, and democratic principles when people address issues and problems in government and civil society.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to identify how early civilizations fostered social responsibility. Students will be able to identify similarities and differences in civic virtues held in early civilizations and those today. Students will be able to identify rights, responsibilities, and privileges of individuals in various early civilizations.	Cross-cutting concepts: • Religion • Community collaboration • Moral codes • Education • Maya – collective labor, personal sacrifice for the greater good, religious rituals, social hierarchies • Inca – <i>mit'a</i> (labor), community-based agriculture and resource management, adherence to Inca code, loyalty to state, worship of state deities • Aztec – mandatory military service, communal projects, Aztec principles, reverence for gods • Ancient China – meritocracy, filial piety, respect for authority/family values • Ancient India – dharmic duties, philosophies, non-violence, diversity, tolerance • Oceania – communal/cooperative labor • Ancient Greece – civic participation/engagement, philosophical discourse, military duty, laws • Ancient Rome – military service, taxes, adherence to Roman principles, duty, loyalty, participation

Rules, Processes, and Laws

D2.Civ.12.6-8. Assess specific rules and laws (both actual and proposed) as means of addressing public problems.

D2.Civ.14.6-8. Compare historical and contemporary means of changing societies and promoting the common good.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to explain how early civilizations established law and order.	Cross-cutting concepts: • leadership role • cultural and philosophical values • infrastructure development • legal and administrative reforms • religious influence • centralized authority • punishment • deterrence • codification of social norms Regional Connections • Maya, Aztec, Inca: Highly religious, hierarchical, and centralized. Changes came from elite or divine interpretations. • Ancient Greece and Rome: Provided the roots of democratic and legal principles still seen today. • China and India: Influenced by philosophy/religion (Confucianism, Hinduism), blending centralized and localized governance. • Oceania: More localized, oral tradition-based governance, with strong environmental and spiritual connections.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Civilizations • Maya – Law/rules codified in hieroglyphs, enforced by kings; Religious and social order through kings and priests; city-state specific; severe punishments, order maintained; theocratic-monarchy; elite councils • Inca – Centralized under Sapa Inca; no written laws but quipu records; unity, labor, infrastructure; strict top-down governance; mit'a labor system; social stability, but little personal freedom; autocratic; centralized bureaucracy; resource control; religious/social order. • Aztec – Codified laws; many in Codex Mendoza; war, tribute, religious order; military and religious enforcers; centralized from Tenochtitlán; harsh penalties; strict social hierarchy; emperor advised by noble councils; codification of crimes, imperial authority. • Ancient China – Legalism, Confucianism; written codes (e.g., Qin and Han laws); harmony, obedience, order; imperial bureaucracy, scholar-officials; dynastic cycle; public works, exams; centralized monarchy; civil service; meritocratic/bureaucratic governance. • Ancient India – Dharma and Manusmriti; caste-based laws; social hierarchy, religious duty; local assemblies and royal courts; rigid caste system, but order preserved; mixed: monarchies, republics, village panchayats; religious diversity, moral principles. • Oceania – Oral laws; kapu system (sacred prohibitions); maintain divine order, resource control; chiefs enforced spiritual taboos; social cohesion but limited mobility; chiefdoms; consensus in councils; adherence to tradition, cultural practices. • Ancient Greece – Written laws; e.g., Draco, Solon; justice, equality (esp. in Athens); citizen assemblies, courts; flourishing of democracy, but instability; varied: democracy (Athens), oligarchy (Sparta); democratic laws, civic participation.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	• Ancient Rome – Twelve Tables, Justinian Code; order, justice, imperial control; Magistrates, Senate, Emperor; legal legacy - rights for some, repression for others; Republic (Senate), then autocracy (Empire); justice, protection, legal uniformity.

Resources

[**Ancient Greece and Rome**](#) - **Core Knowledge:** Free downloadable curriculum; Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections.

[**Can You Read Shang? The Story of China**](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** In this activity, students use the *Can You Read Shang?* quiz to learn about the structure of Shang writing and how it differs from English.

[**Maya, Aztec, and Inca Civilizations**](#) - **Core Knowledge:** Free downloadable curriculum; Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections; Grade 5 level.

[**Which Emperor Are You? The Story of China**](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** In this activity, students use the *Which Emperor Are You?* quiz to explore the nature of leadership in Chinese history. After completing this lesson, students will be able to describe and evaluate the leadership qualities of emperors and empresses in China's history. [Emperor Backgrounds](#).

Economics

Note: National Economy Indicators are not in grade 6 in this scope and sequence and will be addressed and assessed in grades 7 and 8.

Theme: Connecting Worlds

Economic Decision Making

D2.Eco.1.6-8. Explain how economic decisions affect the well-being of individuals, businesses, and society.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to examine factors that influenced economic decisions within early civilizations. Students will be able to explain how early civilizations addressed similar and different economic issues.	Cross-cutting concepts: • Agrarian societies to trade networks • Urbanization • Technological advances in agriculture • Manufacturing • Transportation • Increased productivity • Economic interdependence • Complex social structures • Farming techniques, water management, resource allocation – including labor, city-state alliances, navigation and exploration, short vs. long-distance trade (Silk Road), sustainability, investments – infrastructure, military

Exchange and Markets

D2.Eco.3.6-8. Explain the roles of buyers and sellers in product, labor, and financial markets.

D2.Eco.6.6-8. Explain how changes in supply and demand cause changes in prices and quantities of goods and services, labor, credit, and foreign currencies.

D2.Eco.7.6-8. Analyze the role of innovation and entrepreneurship in a market economy.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to explain how markets in early civilizations facilitated the exchange of goods, services, and labor. Students will be able to explain human, natural, and capital resources in early civilizations.	• Barter and exchange, Commodity money, precious metals, transition to metal coins • Economic specialization, labor systems – slave labor, caste systems, bureaucracies, craftsmen, artisans, trade guilds; natural resources – agriculture, mining, fishing, timber; trade networks. Maya – Primarily barter system; cacao beans and obsidian used as a form of currency. Inca – No formal money system; used quipu (knotted strings) for record-keeping; relied heavily on mit'a labor tax and barter. Aztec – Barter-based; cacao beans and cotton cloth (called quachtli) used as currency. Ancient China – Early use of cowry shells; later, bronze coins; during the Zhou and Qin dynasties, round coins with square holes became common. Ancient India – Barter system early on; later, silver and copper coins were introduced by the Maurya and Gupta Empires. Oceania – Mostly barter; some used shell money (e.g., in Solomon Islands); trade occurred between islands for resources. Ancient Greece – Used coins (silver, bronze); Athens' currency was the drachma; trade was significant in city-states.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Ancient Rome – Coin-based economy with denarii (silver) and aurei (gold); trade and taxes were monetized. Human, natural and capital resources: • Maya: Farmers, builders, astronomers, scribes; maize, cacao, limestone, jade; temples, pyramids, tools • Inca: Terraced farmers, engineers, runners (chasquis); gold, silver, potatoes, llamas; roads, bridges, quipu, agricultural tools • Aztec: Warriors, traders, artisans, priests; Lake Texcoco, obsidian, cacao, maize; Chinampas, temples, market infrastructure • Ancient China: Farmers, silk workers, soldiers, scholars; silk, jade, tea, rice, metals; Great Wall, iron tools, paper, plows • Ancient India: Farmers, traders, metalworkers, priests; cotton, spices, precious gems, fertile land; irrigation, tools, temples, urban planning (Harappa) • Oceania: Fishermen, navigators, farmers; fish, coconuts, volcanic soil, wood; canoes, fishing nets, communal structures • Ancient Greece: Philosophers, artisans, sailors, soldiers; olives, grapes, marble, silver; ships, temples, coin minting, tools • Ancient Rome: Soldiers, builders, farmers, engineers; timber, iron, olives, wine, marble; aqueducts, roads, coliseums, military tools

The Global Economy

D2.Eco.14.6-8. Explain barriers to trade and how those barriers influence trade among nations.

D2.Eco.15.6-8. Explain the benefits and the costs of trade policies to individuals, businesses, and society

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will explain how the costs and benefits of trade between early civilizations contributed to cultural development, economic growth, and interdependence.	Cross-cutting: Cultural exchange – colonization conquests, trade, spread of religion; economic impact – trade; political changes – development of city-states, rise and fall of empires • Geographic barriers – mountainous terrain, islands, lakes, varied/vast landscapes, deserts • Lack of technology/transportation – limited advancements • Infrastructure – not well-developed • Internal strife, external invasions, military campaigns disrupt • Political barriers – wars, closed borders • Cultural/language differences Incas (South America – Andes Mountains) • Barriers: Steep mountains, lack of wheeled vehicles, no written language. • Impact: Trade was mostly local. Used llama caravans and built roads and bridges to connect their empire.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Aztecs (Central Mexico) • Barriers: Swampy land (Lake Texcoco), surrounded by rivals. • Impact: Built chinampas (floating gardens) to create fertile farmland on swampy lakebeds; Constructed causeways, dikes, and canals to connect their island capital and control flooding; Developed strong military alliances (Triple Alliance) to defend against and dominate neighboring rivals. Mayas (Mesoamerica – jungles) • Barriers: Dense rainforests, lack of rivers for easy transport. • Impact: Trade was by foot or canoe, often limited in distance. Cities traded luxury goods like jade and cacao. Ancient China • Barriers: Deserts (Gobi), mountains (Himalayas), oceans. • Impact: Limited early contact with the West but eventually created the Silk Road to trade goods like silk and porcelain. Ancient India • Barriers: Himalayas, monsoon seasons. • Impact: Mountains blocked northern trade, but rivers and seas enabled trade with Mesopotamia and East Africa. Major center for spice and textile trade. Ancient Greece • Barriers: Mountains divided city-states, poor farmland. • Impact: Encouraged sea trade and colonization. Greeks became skilled sailors trading olive oil, wine, pottery.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Ancient Rome • Barriers: Few natural barriers within empire, but external threats and pirates. • Impact: Created roads and protected sea routes. Controlled trade across Europe, Asia, and Africa Ancient Oceania (Pacific Islands) • Barriers: Vast ocean distances, limited natural resources. • Impact: Used canoes and star navigation to trade items like obsidian, shells, and food. Trade was inter-island and risky. War and conflict can: • Damage trade and reduce wealth • Destroy farmland and cities • Increase taxes or tribute to fund armies • Shift power between regions or leaders • Sometimes lead to new resources through conquest Incas: • Conflict Impact: Civil war weakened the empire just before Spanish arrival. • Economic Effects: War disrupted farming and the mita labor system, damaging food production and infrastructure; after conquest, Spanish took gold/silver.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Aztecs: • Conflict Impact: Constant warfare to collect tribute and captives. Economic Effects: Empire grew rich from tribute, but the system was unstable—many enemies joined the Spanish to overthrow the Aztecs, ending their economy. Mayas: • Conflict Impact: Frequent city-state wars. • Economic Effects: Wars weakened agriculture, led to abandoned cities, and disrupted long-distance trade. Likely contributed to the collapse of some major cities. Ancient China: • Conflict Impact: Long periods of war, like the Warring States Period. • Economic Effects: War destroyed farmland and displaced people, but also pushed innovation in infrastructure (roads, canals, walls). Unified under empires like the Han helped restore trade. Ancient India: • Conflict Impact: Invasions (e.g., by Persians, Greeks, Huns). • Economic Effects: Some wars hurt trade routes like the Silk Road; others, like the Maurya Empire's unification, boosted trade and taxes. War created shifts in power and economic stability.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Ancient Greece: • Conflict Impact: Wars between city-states (I Peloponnesian War) and with outsiders (like Persians). Economic Effects: Wars drained resources, destroyed crops, and disrupted trade. Athens, once rich, lost power and wealth after the Peloponnesian War. Ancient Rome: • Conflict Impact: Frequent wars of conquest and later civil wars. • Economic Effects: Early conquests brought wealth and slaves, growing the economy. But later wars drained resources, ruined trade, and contributed to Rome's decline. Oceania: • Conflict Impact: Small-scale tribal wars and resource competition. • Economic Effects: Limited warfare due to isolation, but conflicts could damage canoes, crops, or cause population loss, reducing trade and food security.

Resources

[**Ancient Greece and Rome**](#) - **Core Knowledge:** Free downloadable curriculum; Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections.

[**Economics in Ancient India**](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** Students will read a short history of the Indus Valley Civilization and its trading patterns. They will complete a chart with notes from the reading and address a prompt that requires them to analyze these trading patterns.

[Maya, Aztec, and Inca Civilizations](#) - **Core Knowledge:** Free downloadable curriculum; Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections; Grade 5 level.

Geography

Theme: Shaping Civilizations

Geographic Representations: Views of the World

D2.Geo.3.6-8. Use paper based and electronic mapping and graphing techniques to represent and analyze spatial patterns of different environmental and cultural characteristics.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to identify locations and characteristics (environmental and cultural) of various societies and early civilizations to help them explain patterns and relationships.	Cross-cutting concepts – geographic diversity, cultural uniqueness; resource utilization • Maya – present day Mexico, Guatemala, Belize, Honduras, El Salvador; river valleys, rainforests, limestone plateaus; city-states, architecture, hieroglyphics, trade, agriculture • Inca – Andes, including present-day Peru, Ecuador, Chile, Bolivia; mountains, high-altitude plateaus; terraced agriculture, architecture, engineering, labor system • Aztec – valley of Mexico, present day Mexico City; mountains, lakes, volcanoes; floating gardens, calendar, temples • Ancient China – Eastern Asia, mountains, plains, rivers; river valleys, Himalayas; agricultural innovations, Great Wall, Silk Road, Confucianism, Daoism, Legalism • Ancient India – South Asia, including present-day India, Pakistan, Bangladesh; Ganges River basin, diverse geography, Hinduism, Buddhism, arts, science, caste system • Oceania – Central and South pacific, including Hawaii; tropical climate, volcanic activity, diverse ecosystem; traditions and rituals, navigation/seafaring, agriculture • Ancient Greece – southern Europe including Balkan and islands in Aegean; Mediterranean climate; city-states, art, literature, architecture • Ancient Rome – Italian peninsula, later empire covered parts of Europe, Africa, Middle East; Mediterranean climate; republican governance

Human-Environment Interaction: Place, Regions, and Culture

D2.Geo.4.6-8. Explain how cultural patterns and economic decisions influence environments and the daily lives of people in both nearby and distant places.

D2.Geo.5.6-8. Analyze the combinations of cultural and environmental characteristics that make places both similar to and different from other places.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will compare and contrast the physical, environmental, and human characteristics of different early civilizations.	Cross-cutting concepts: • water management – terraced farming, aqueducts, irrigation • agricultural practices – terraced farming, slash and burn, irrigation systems • trade and transportation – access to rivers, seas, roads

Human Population: Spatial Patterns & Movement

D2.Geo.7.6-8. Explain how changes in transportation and communication technology influence the spatial connections among human settlements and affect the diffusion of ideas and cultural practices.

D2.Geo.9.6-8. Evaluate the influences of long-term human-induced environmental change on spatial patterns of conflict and cooperation.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will evaluate the positive and negative effects of long-term human activities—such as settlement, agriculture, and early technologies—on the environment and sustainability of early civilizations. Students will analyze how transportation systems, land use, and resource management practices in early civilizations contributed to both the growth and decline of those societies.	Cross cutting concepts: Trade and cultural exchange, language, cultural assimilation • Culture (e.g., religion/beliefs, accepted practices/traditions) • Specialization of labor • Mastery of food supply • Economic systems • Education • Communication systems (e.g., spoken language, alphabetic and/or numeric systems, hieroglyphics, illustrations) • Technological advancements: metallurgy, weaponry, tools • Engineering and architecture: grid layouts, urban planning, roads, pyramids, monuments, temples, palaces, floating gardens, printing, papermaking, seed drill, plow • Agricultural advancements: terrace farming, irrigation • Military: weaponry, strategy, gunpowder • Government: meritocracy, leadership structure, urban planning, legal systems • Medicine • Astronomy • Philosophy

Global Interconnections: Changing Spatial Patterns

D2.Geo.10.6-8. Analyze the ways in which cultural and environmental characteristics vary among various regions of the world.

D2.Geo.11.6-8. Explain how the relationship between the environmental characteristics of places and production of goods influences the spatial patterns of world trade.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to explain how the environmental and cultural features of early civilizations influenced economic activities and expansion.	• Cultural exchange – colonization conquests, trade, spread of religion, cultural diffusion, migrations, blending of religious ideas, caste system developed (India) • Economic impact – trade; new roads and cities built, increase in farming/agricultural practices • Political changes – development of city-states, rise and fall of empires, wars/conquests

Resources

[Ancient Math and Music](#) - **PBS Learning Media**: Explore how Pythagoras and Plato found mathematics in music and nature in this video from NOVA: The Great Math Mystery. The ancient Greeks identified three pleasing musical intervals: an octave, a fifth, and a fourth. Pythagoras discovered that the beautiful musical relationship between the notes was also a mathematical relationship: the harmonious sounds are produced by vibrating strings with particular ratios of string length. Plato believed geometry and mathematics exist in their own ideal world and that certain shapes (now known as the Platonic solids) were associated with the classical elements from which the world was made - earth, fire, air, water, and the universe; discussion questions provided.

Chinese Innovation - **C3 IDM:** This IDM is described as being for grades 3-5 but can be utilized in Grade 6 with minimal adaptation. This inquiry provides students with an opportunity to examine nine of China's most impactful innovations and their contributions to the modern world. These innovations and inventions fall into three categories: 1) Communication innovations, including written language, paper, and printing; 2) Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math (STEM) innovations, including the compass, the Great Wall of China, gunpowder, and fireworks, and; 3) Economic innovations, including common currency, silk, and the Silk Road.

Mapping Populations: The Ancient World - **PBS Learning Media:** Students will study choropleth maps of the ancient world, and the population density changes from 3000 BC to 1 CE. Then, they will fill out a chart about the major influential factors in population density, and answer questions about the map.

Nomadic Life - **C3 IDM:** This inquiry leads students through an investigation of prehistoric nomadic life. By investigating the compelling question "How do we know the past without written evidence?" students evaluate how nomads communicated, where they lived, and how they defined their needs based on the places they lived. The formative performance tasks build on knowledge and skills through the course of the inquiry and help students develop understanding of nomadic life to compare with agrarian life. Students create an evidence-based argument about how non-written artifacts support understanding of nomadic life during prehistoric times.

Where in China Is...? - **PBS Learning Media:** In this activity, students examine and plot different locations that hold historical importance. Students will also use the interactive game *Where in China is...?* to study and test their knowledge of Chinese geography.

Writings of the Ancient Maya - **PBS Learning Media:** In this interactive lesson supporting literacy skills, students are introduced to the ancient Mayan civilization through their writings. Students develop their literacy skills as they explore a social studies focus on the destruction of many Mayan writings by the Spanish and what archaeologists have learned from the writings that remain. During this process, they read informational text, learn and practice vocabulary words, and explore content through a video and interactive activities.

History

***Note:** C3 indicators for Historical Sources and Evidence are woven into the Inquiry Process.

Theme: Building Societies

Change, Continuity, and Context

D2.His.1.6-8. Analyze connections among events and developments in broader historical contexts.

D2.His.2.6-8. Classify series of historical events and developments as examples of change and/or continuity.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to explain patterns of change in early civilizations (e.g., rise and fall of empires). Students will explain the social, political, economic, and environmental influences that contributed to major changes in early civilizations and assess how these influences shaped long-term outcomes.	Cross-cutting Concepts: religion, agriculture, infrastructure, social governmental hierarchies, cultural achievements Maya – City-states with kingship; ruled by divine kings to maintain order, oversee economy, conduct religious rituals; King, nobles, priests, commoners • Agriculturally based society with complex city planning, monumental architecture, hieroglyphic writing; knowledge of astronomy Inca – Centralized ruler with supreme leader (Sapa) with bureaucratic system; rulers seen as descendants of gods; purpose to control vast territories, maintain order, manage resources • Advanced agriculture, extensive roads, labor system for largescale projects Aztec – Centralized emperor, aided by council of nobles and military leaders; empire expanded through conquest; purpose to govern conquered territories, conduct religious rituals • Advanced agriculture, monuments, extensive trade

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Continue	Ancient China – Dynastic rule with emperors as political and religious leaders; concept of Mandate of Heaven, maintain social harmony, conduct rituals, civil service exams Advanced bureaucracy, Confucian influence, Great Wall, science and technology Ancient India (Maurya and Gupta) – Emperor Ashoka (Maurya), regional rulers (Gupta); religious philosophies governed to uphold dharma, protect, economic prosperity; administrative units and decentralization • Math, medicine, art, governance influence by Buddhism and Hinduism Oceania – Chiefdoms/chiefs ruling over extensive family units to maintain order, economy, religious ceremonies; chiefdoms, priests, warriors, commoners • Navigational skills, long-distance voyages, religious practices, complex social structures Ancient Greece – City-states with various forms of government (democracy in Athens, oligarchy in Sparta); varied structures – assemblies, councils, magistrates for defense, civil life and participatory governance • Philosophy, literature, political experimentation, architecture Roman Republic and Empire – Republic with elected officials; transitioned to emperor rule; elected officials (senate, consul) later emperors for legal justice and military expansion • Legal systems, engineering (aqueducts, roads)

Perspectives

D2.His.4.6-8. Analyze multiple factors that influenced the perspectives of people during different historical eras.

D2.His.5.6-8. Explain how and why perspectives of people have changed over time.

D2.His.6.6-8. Analyze how people's perspectives influenced what information is available in the historical sources they created.

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to compare and contrast perspectives in early civilizations over time (e.g., caste system).	• Religion/Culture (new beliefs can lead to peace or conflict; diversification) • Leaders (good or bad rulers affect people's trust; resource management, governance) • Invasions/Conquests (often bring new culture or destroy old ones; external and internal threats) • Trade and Travel (new ideas spread; trade networks; disease spread) • Technology and Writing (how people learn and remember things; engineering, military advances; seafaring/maritime abilities, cultural achievements, agricultural innovation)

Causation and Argumentation

D2.His.14.6-8. Explain multiple causes and effects of events and developments in the past.

D2.His.15.6-8. Evaluate the relative influence of various causes of events and developments in the past

Sample C3 Indicator Connections	Sample Content Connections
Students will be able to identify and explain multiple causes and effects of key events and developments in early civilizations. Students will be able to explain the environmental impacts of human innovation on early civilizations.	Cross-cutting concepts: Trade and cultural exchange, language, cultural assimilation, colonization conquests, spread of religion; political changes – development of city-states, rise and fall of empires • Government/leadership structure • Culture (e.g., religion/beliefs, accepted practices/traditions) • Specialization of labor • Mastery of food supply • Technology • Economic systems • Education • Communication systems (e.g., spoken language, alphabetic and/or numeric systems, hieroglyphics, illustrations)

Resources

[An Age of Empires and Interchange](#) - History Project UC-Irvine: What were the effects of the exchanges on the Silk Road?” and “What is Hellenistic culture and how did it spread among regions in Afroeurasia?” are just two of the 6th grade Curricular Resources provided by the History Project, which allows students to study the characteristics of the ancient civilizations (social, political, religious, economic, and cultural), and how they were able to grow in size, complexity, and power.

Ancient Greece and Rome - Core Knowledge: Free downloadable curriculum; Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections.

Angkor What? Angkor Wat! - National Endowment for the Humanities: Beginning in the 9th century, the Khmer empire, which was based in what is today northwestern Cambodia, began to gather power and territory in mainland Southeast Asia. It would grow to be one of the largest empires in Southeast Asian history. In this lesson, students will learn about Angkor Wat and its place in Cambodian, and Southeast Asian, history. Students will attempt to 'read' the temple, in a way which resembles the reading of a primary document, to gain insight into this history.

Aztec - C3 IDM: This annotated inquiry is listed as for 9th grade, but the compelling question, "What Do the Buried Secrets of Tenochtitlán Tell Us About the Aztecs?" and the staging question, where students look at photographs of the excavation of Tenochtitlán in 2012, can be used/adapted for 6th graders to formulate questions about the Aztec city.

Feudal Japan - Core Knowledge: Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide (p. 77-153) and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections; focused on grade 5.

Marco Polo, Ibn Battuta, and Zheng He-Early Connectors - PBS Learning Media: In this lesson, students will explore the adventures of these three world travelers. After viewing three short videos about their journeys, students will analyze photographs of a city that all three travelers visited, write a log entry describing a sighting of Zheng He's fleet of ships, and then read excerpts from Marco Polo's and Ibn Battuta's accounts of their journeys. The lesson will conclude with students writing a short play in which the three travelers meet and share stories of their adventures.

Maya, Aztec, and Inca Civilizations - Core Knowledge: Free downloadable curriculum; Scroll to bottom of page to download individual PDF documents: Teacher Guide and Student Reader. Guide provides activities, assessments and literary selections; grade 5 level.

Native America - PBS Learning Media: This [Native America](#) collection reaches back 15,000 years, examining ancient city planning and early systems of science and spirituality and extends to present-day exploration of Indigenous knowledge and language preservation; focus on Incas and Aztecs with video clips and discussion questions.

The Story of India - PBS.org: From ancient to modern times, India has played a central role in human history. The Story of India offers educational resources for teachers on this web site. The lessons are designed for high school world history

but can be adapted for lower grades as needed and many of the resources are aligned for either grades 5-12 or 7-12. Provides photos gallery, timeline, and lesson plans.

World History - OER Project: OER provides a collection of free activities, lesson plans, and other teaching resources related to topics in World History - such as Economic Networks and Trade, Cross Cultural Exchange, and Shifting Populations. These can be adapted for 6th graders or identified through a search of [Middle School](#) specific lessons.

Writings of the Ancient Maya - PBS Learning Media: In this interactive lesson supporting literacy skills, students are introduced to the ancient Mayan civilization through their writings. Students develop their literacy skills as they explore a social studies focus on the destruction of many Mayan writings by the Spanish and what archaeologists have learned from the writings that remain. During this process, they read informational text, learn and practice vocabulary words, and explore content through a video and interactive activities.